ENTERPRISE CONSULTING CASE STUDY

SAP Ariba Adoption Intelligence & Procurement Transformation

Turning KPI data into clear business decisions

Project detail	Description
Project role	Solutions Consultant / Enterprise Analytics Consultant
Client	Fictional multinational enterprise
Business area	Procurement, supplier management and SAP Ariba adoption
Primary tool	Microsoft Excel 365
Source dataset	SAP_ARIBA_SRC_ADOPTION_METRIC_MASTER_DATA_MA.csv
Dashboard	SAP_Ariba_Adoption_Intelligence_Dashboard.xlsx
Project type	Portfolio simulation — not a real client engagement

IMPORTANT — READ THIS FIRST
The SAP KPI catalogue is the original supplied dataset. The customer, business-unit, regional and monthly performance records in the Excel workbook are synthetic examples created for demonstration. All performance results and recommendations based on those records are illustrative, not real SAP customer results.

Prepared as a portfolio project to demonstrate business analysis, data assessment, solution design, Excel dashboard development and practical consulting recommendations.

1. Executive summary

A large organisation may use SAP Ariba across several teams, countries and procurement activities. However, having a system in place does not automatically mean that employees and business units are using it consistently or getting the expected value from it.

In this case study, a fictional multinational organisation asked for a clearer way to monitor SAP Ariba adoption and performance. The proposed solution brings its KPI definitions and illustrative performance records into one Excel reporting workbook. Managers can review overall performance, compare SAP Ariba solutions, explore business-unit and regional differences, and identify areas that may need attention.

The project starts with the supplied SAP Ariba KPI master file. Because that file contains KPI definitions rather than actual performance transactions, a separate synthetic dataset was created to demonstrate how the reporting solution could work once real performance data becomes available.

In plain language
The project turns a list of SAP Ariba measures into a management view: what is being measured, how performance compares with the target, where gaps appear, and what the organisation should investigate next.

What was delivered

- Reviewed and organised the original SAP Ariba KPI catalogue.
- Created clearly labelled sample performance data for five fictional customers, 15 business units and 24 months.
- Structured the workbook into dashboard, detail, exception, master-data and methodology sheets.
- Built views for executive performance, solution adoption, KPI performance, regional and business-unit comparison, exceptions and strategic insights.
- Documented calculation rules, assumptions, risks and a practical improvement roadmap.

2. Client background and business situation

The fictional client, Meridian Global Industries, is presented as a multinational business with procurement teams spread across regions and business units. It uses several SAP Ariba capabilities to support sourcing, buying, contracts, supplier lifecycle activities and supplier risk management.

The organisation wants to answer straightforward management questions: Are teams using the available capabilities? Are important KPIs meeting agreed targets? Are there differences between regions? Which gaps need an owner and an action?

Stakeholder	What they need to understand
Chief Procurement Officer	Is the procurement transformation delivering the expected results?
Regional procurement leaders	Which business units are behind and where should support be focused?
SAP Ariba product / platform team	Which solution areas and KPIs need attention?
Business-unit managers	What is happening in their teams and what actions are expected?
Data / reporting team	Are KPI definitions, data sources and calculations consistent?

3. Business problem

The core problem is not simply a lack of charts. It is a lack of one consistent view of adoption and performance that business and technology teams can both understand.

Problem area	What it means in everyday language	Why it matters
Scattered reporting	Different teams may maintain their own spreadsheets or reports.	Leaders cannot easily compare results.
Unclear KPI definitions	Teams may interpret the same measure differently.	Reports may not tell a consistent story.

Limited adoption visibility	The organisation may not know which capabilities are actively used.	Low usage can reduce the value of the platform.
Slow issue identification	Performance gaps may be noticed late.	Teams lose time before acting.
Weak ownership	It may not be clear who should fix a KPI gap.	Issues can remain unresolved.

Problem statement

The business problem
The organisation needs a simple, trusted and repeatable way to monitor SAP Ariba adoption and KPI performance across solutions, regions and business units, so leaders can identify gaps and take action.

4. Project objectives and scope

Objectives

- Create a single reporting view for the SAP Ariba KPI catalogue and related performance measures.
- Make performance easy to understand for both business and technical users.
- Compare actual results with agreed targets using consistent calculation rules.
- Highlight low adoption, underperformance and changes over time.
- Provide practical recommendations and a phased improvement plan.

In scope

- Review the 48 KPI definitions supplied in the source file.
- Create an illustrative data model and synthetic performance records.
- Build an Excel dashboard and supporting analysis sheets.
- Document measures, filters, assumptions, risks and recommendations.

Out of scope

- Connecting to a live SAP Ariba tenant or extracting production customer data.
- Changing SAP Ariba configuration or business processes.
- Proving actual savings, compliance improvements or adoption outcomes.
- Deploying a production data pipeline or enterprise reporting service.

5. Data assessment: what the source file contains

The original CSV is a KPI master-data file. It describes what can be measured; it does not contain the results of those measurements.

Source field	Simple explanation
Solution	The SAP Ariba solution area the KPI belongs to.
KPIId	The unique code used to identify a KPI.
KPIName	The full name of the measure.
KPIShortName	A shorter label used for grouping or display.
KPIShortNameOrderId	The display order for a short-name group.
KPIOrderId	The display order of the KPI within its solution.
KPIShortNameforCharts	A shorter label suitable for chart axes.

Source data check	Result
Rows and columns	48 rows and 7 columns
Unique KPI IDs	48
SAP Ariba solution areas	5
Blank KPI IDs / duplicate KPI IDs	None identified in the supplied catalogue
Text clean-up	Some labels contain trailing spaces; cleaned in the supporting dimension while original master values are preserved.

SAP Ariba solution	KPI definitions
ARIBA BUYING	9
ARIBA CONTRACTS	11
ARIBA SOURCING	12
SLP	11
SUPPLIER RISK	5

Important data limitation
The source file does not contain actual adoption percentages, transaction counts, customers, business units, reporting dates, targets or historical results. Those fields were added as synthetic examples so that the Excel dashboard could demonstrate the intended reporting experience.

6. Supporting data created for the demonstration

To make the dashboard interactive, the workbook includes synthetic sample records. They are designed to show how the solution could work when connected to real, approved business data.

Dataset	What it represents	How it is used
KPI Master	The original 48 SAP Ariba KPI definitions.	Defines which KPIs can be reported.
Customer Master	Five fictional enterprise customers.	Allows customer-level filtering.
Business Unit Master	15 fictional business units.	Allows comparison between teams.
Region Master	Five illustrative regions.	Supports regional reporting.
Calendar	Monthly reporting dates over 24 months.	Supports trend analysis.
KPI Performance Fact	17,280 synthetic KPI records.	Provides sample actuals, targets and period comparisons.

The generated fact table covers November 2024 to October 2026. The dashboard opens with a default reporting window of November 2025 to October 2026, which contains 8,640 sample records.

How the data model works

The KPI performance table is the central table. Each record represents one KPI for one business unit in one reporting month. It links to the KPI, customer, business unit and region reference tables. This structure makes it possible to filter and compare the same measure consistently.

Example record component	Example meaning
Reporting period	October 2026
Business unit	A fictional procurement team
KPI ID	A code from the original SAP KPI master
Actual value	A generated sample result
Target value	An illustrative sample target
Performance status	A calculated label based on actual versus target

7. Proposed solution and workbook design

The solution is an Excel-based reporting workbook. It uses the original KPI master data, supporting sample tables and formula-driven calculations to present information in a structured way.

Workbook sheet	Purpose	Main user question
Executive Dashboard	Summary of performance and key measures.	How are we doing overall?
Solution Adoption	Comparison across SAP Ariba solution areas.	Which solution areas are performing well?
KPI Performance	Detailed KPI results, target comparison and ranking.	Which measures need attention?
Regional & BU Analytics	Regional and business-unit comparisons.	Where are the differences?
Exception Management	Low performance and adoption issues.	What needs follow-up?
Strategic Insights	Summary of findings and suggested actions.	What should management do next?
KPI Master	Original SAP KPI definitions.	What is each KPI?
Fact Data	Synthetic monthly KPI performance records.	What sample data drives the analysis?
Supporting Dimensions	Customer, region, business unit and KPI reference data.	How are records grouped?
Data Dictionary & Methodology	Definitions, assumptions and calculation notes.	How should the numbers be understood?
Calc_Engine	Formula layer supporting the report sheets.	How are dashboard figures calculated?

How a user works with the dashboard

1. Open the Executive Dashboard and choose the reporting period.
2. Select a solution, region, business unit or other available filter.
3. Review the summary cards and charts.
4. Open the KPI Performance or Exception Management sheet to see the detail behind a result.
5. Use the Strategic Insights sheet to review the key messages and suggested follow-up.

The current workbook uses dropdown-based filter selectors on the Executive Dashboard. The build notes state that PivotTable slicers have not been created. This should be understood as a current implementation detail, not as a missing business requirement.

8. KPI and calculation approach

The dashboard uses two different ideas that should not be confused: adoption and target achievement.

Measure	Plain-language definition	How it is calculated in this workbook
Adoption rate	How many monitored KPI records show some activity.	Records with an actual value above zero divided by all monitored records.
Target achievement	How actual performance compares with target, with KPI scales normalised before combining different measures.	Sum of normalised actual values divided by sum of normalised target values.
KPI achievement	How one KPI performed across the selected period.	Total actual value for that KPI divided by its total target.
Variance	The difference between actual and target.	Actual value minus target value for the selected KPI.
Performance status	A label that helps users identify performance quickly.	On Target at 100% or more; At Risk from 85% to below 100%; Below Target below 85%. Zero actuals are labelled Not Adopted.

Why normalisation matters

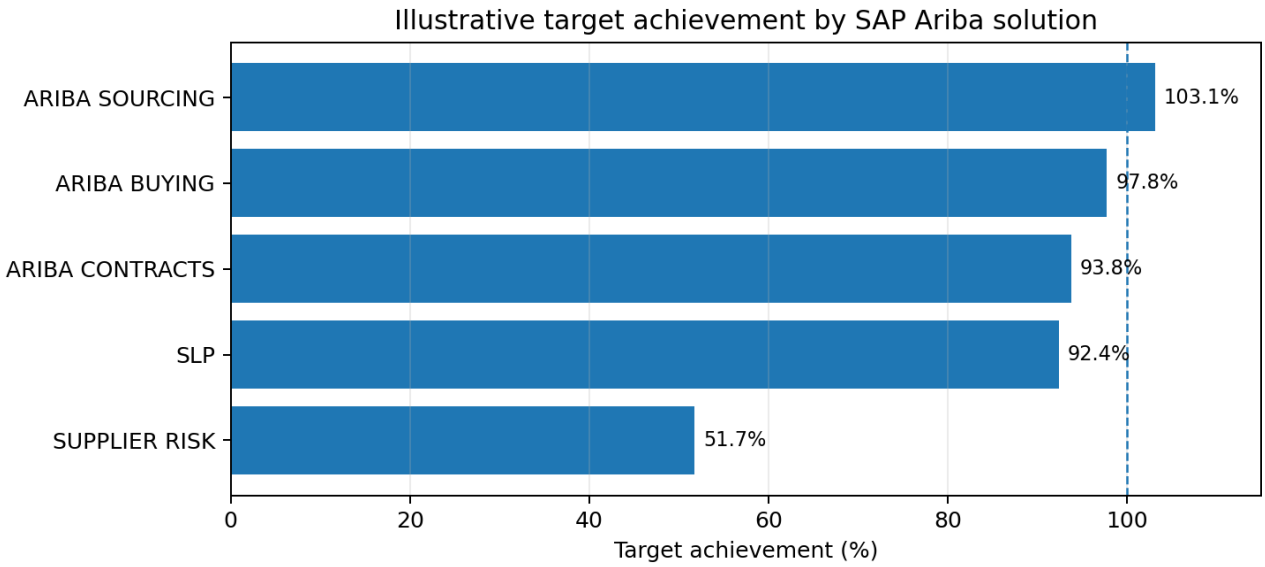
Some KPIs are counts and others are percentages. Adding their raw values together can give too much influence to measures with larger numbers. The workbook uses an illustrative scale for each KPI before calculating the combined target-achievement score. These scales and targets are assumptions for the simulation and must be replaced with approved business definitions in a live project.

9. Dashboard findings — illustrative results

The figures below are calculated from the workbook's synthetic data using the default dashboard filters: all solutions, customers, regions and business units, from November 2025 to October 2026.

Measure	Illustrative result	How to read it
Monitored records	8,640	48 KPIs across 15 business units over 12 months.
Overall target achievement	92.1%	Combined scale-normalised actual performance compared with target.
Adoption rate	95.8%	Share of monitored records with a non-zero actual value.
KPIs meeting or exceeding target	10 of 48	KPI-level achievement is at least 100%.
KPIs in the at-risk band	33 of 48	KPI-level achievement is at least 85% but below 100%.
KPIs below the 85% threshold	5 of 48	KPI-level achievement is below the illustrative at-risk threshold.

Solution-level comparison



In this simulated dataset, Ariba Sourcing has the strongest combined target achievement, while Supplier Risk has the largest performance gap. The Supplier Risk result is especially important to investigate because its illustrative adoption rate is 60%, compared with 100% in the other four solution areas.

Solution	Target achievement	Adoption rate
ARIBA SOURCING	103.1%	100.0%
ARIBA BUYING	97.8%	100.0%
ARIBA CONTRACTS	93.8%	100.0%
SLP	92.4%	100.0%
SUPPLIER RISK	51.7%	60.0%

Regional comparison

Region	Target achievement	Adoption rate
Asia Pacific	98.1%	96.5%
Europe	94.2%	100.0%
Middle East & Africa	92.2%	89.6%
North America	88.7%	94.8%
Latin America	87.0%	94.8%

In the sample data, Asia Pacific has the highest regional target achievement (98.1%), while Latin America has the lowest (87.0%). This is a signal for further investigation, not proof that geography caused the difference.

Business-unit comparison

Business unit	Region	Target achievement	Adoption
Atlas - Renewables	North America	68.1%	89.6%
Meridian - Shared Services APAC	Asia Pacific	106.9%	100.0%

The weakest illustrative business unit is Atlas - Renewables; the strongest is Meridian - Shared Services APAC. The next step would be to drill into the specific KPIs and check whether the gap relates to low usage, process differences, target setting, data quality or reporting behaviour.

Trend observation

The combined monthly achievement in the synthetic data is 89.7% in 2025-11 and 87.7% in 2026-10. The endpoint comparison is lower by 1.9 percentage points. This does not prove a steady decline across every month; it indicates that the trend should be reviewed and explained.

10. What the findings may mean for the business

Finding from sample data	Possible business meaning	What to validate with real users
Supplier Risk is materially below target and has lower adoption.	Teams may not be using the capability consistently, or the sample target may be too demanding.	Check which Supplier Risk features are enabled, who uses them, and whether source events are captured.
Ariba Sourcing is above target in the model.	Sourcing activity may be relatively mature in the scenario.	Confirm actual event volumes, quality of sourcing events and business outcomes.
Regional results differ.	Local process, training, configuration or data-capture differences may exist.	Compare operating models, user groups, local policies and data completeness.
Some business units are well below target.	A focused review may be more effective than a company-wide intervention.	Review their KPI-level detail and speak with the business owner.
Overall adoption is higher than overall target achievement.	Some KPI records are active, but activity may still be below target.	Separate 'any activity' from meaningful and successful usage.

11. Recommendations

Priority	Recommendation	Practical next step	Suggested owner
Immediate: 0–30 days	Validate KPI definitions and targets.	Confirm the owner, formula, unit, source and target for each KPI.	Procurement KPI owner + Data team
Immediate: 0–30 days	Investigate Supplier Risk adoption.	Review enabled capabilities, user access, training and source-data capture.	SAP Ariba product owner
Immediate: 0–30 days	Review the lowest-performing business units.	Hold short working sessions and identify the three biggest KPI gaps.	Regional procurement lead
Short term: 30–90 days	Create a common KPI governance process.	Approve one KPI dictionary and a change-control process.	Procurement excellence + Data governance
Short term: 30–90 days	Improve data quality and reporting ownership.	Assign a data owner and validation checks to every important field.	Data owners + IT
Short term: 30–90 days	Introduce regular performance reviews.	Use monthly reviews with named actions, owners and due dates.	Business-unit managers
Long term: 3–12 months	Connect the report to approved live data sources.	Design controlled extraction, refresh, access and audit processes.	IT / Data engineering
Long term: 3–12 months	Measure business outcomes, not only system activity.	Add agreed measures for cycle time, compliance, savings or process quality where reliable data exists.	Procurement leadership

12. Implementation roadmap

Phase	Indicative timing	Main activities	Deliverable / exit point
1. Discovery	Weeks 1–2	Meet stakeholders, understand processes and agree questions.	Approved requirements and scope.
2. Data assessment	Weeks 2–3	Review source systems, KPI definitions, quality and ownership.	Data profile and issue log.
3. Solution design	Weeks 3–4	Agree data model, measures, filters, security and refresh approach.	Approved solution design.
4. Build	Weeks 5–7	Prepare data, develop workbook and configure dashboard views.	Working dashboard and supporting data model.
5. Validate	Weeks 8–9	Check formulas, totals, filters and business interpretation.	Test results and resolved defects.
6. User review	Week 10	Walk through dashboard with business and technical users.	User acceptance sign-off.
7. Release and adoption	Weeks 11–12	Publish controlled version, train	Release pack and user guide.

		users and assign owners.	
8. Continuous improvement	Ongoing	Review KPI definitions, data quality and business value.	Monthly improvement backlog.

The timings are an example planning estimate. A real project plan would depend on data access, system complexity, security reviews, stakeholder availability and integration requirements.

13. Governance, risks and controls

Risk	Why it matters	Suggested control
Unclear KPI definitions	Different teams may report different interpretations of the same KPI.	Maintain an approved KPI dictionary with business owner and calculation.
Synthetic assumptions carried into production	Illustrative targets or sample values could be mistaken for real results.	Clearly separate sample data and replace it only with approved source data.
Incomplete or delayed source data	The dashboard may show an incomplete picture.	Add data freshness checks, reconciliation and a visible reporting date.
Incorrect aggregation	Combining unlike KPI units can distort the overall score.	Use documented KPI scales, weighting and business approval.
Unauthorised access	Sensitive procurement information may be exposed.	Apply role-based access and approved storage locations.
Low user adoption of the report	The workbook may be built but not used consistently.	Train users, simplify navigation and assign owners to monthly reviews.

14. Success measures for a real implementation

The project should not be judged only by whether the Excel workbook opens or contains charts. A real rollout should be measured by whether the information is trusted and used.

- Every priority KPI has an agreed definition, owner, unit and source.
- The reporting data is refreshed on an agreed schedule and passes reconciliation checks.
- Business users can identify low-performing KPIs without manual consolidation.
- Action items have a named owner and due date.
- Leaders use the report in a recurring performance review.
- The organisation can show measurable improvement against an approved baseline.

15. Limitations and assumptions

- The client, customers, business units and regions are fictional.
- The original SAP CSV contains KPI metadata only; it does not contain actual performance values.
- All 17,280 performance records are synthetic and were generated for demonstration.
- Targets, KPI scales, thresholds and generated values are illustrative assumptions, not SAP standards or customer-approved targets.
- The default analysis window is November 2025 to October 2026, even though the generated sample dataset spans November 2024 to October 2026.
- The current workbook uses dropdown selectors; PivotTable slicers are not included in this build.
- No live SAP Ariba connection, production integration, or verified financial benefit is claimed.
- Before production use, KPI owners must validate definitions, units, targets, data lineage, security and calculation rules.

16. Conclusion

This case study shows how a Solutions Consultant can connect a business question to a practical reporting solution. The work begins by understanding what the source data can and cannot tell us. It then structures the information, builds a clear Excel dashboard, explains the results in everyday language and turns the findings into actions.

The most important consulting lesson is that a dashboard is not the final outcome. The real value comes from trusted definitions, reliable data, clear ownership and business teams using the information to make better decisions.

Final message
The Excel dashboard is the reporting tool. The consulting case study explains why it was needed, how it was designed, what the sample results show, what should be checked with real data and how the organisation could move forward.

Appendix A. Simple glossary

Term	Simple meaning
SAP Ariba	A set of business solutions used to support procurement and supplier-related processes.
KPI	A measure used to track performance against an objective.
KPI master data	The list of KPI names, IDs, categories and definitions.
Fact data	Records containing measured results for a period and business area.
Adoption	Whether a capability or process is being used.
Target achievement	How actual performance compares with the agreed target.
Data quality	Whether data is complete, correct, consistent and usable.
Data model	The way tables are organised and connected.
Synthetic data	Artificial sample data created for testing or demonstration.
Business unit	A team or part of the organisation with its own responsibilities.
Data governance	The rules, roles and checks that help keep data reliable.

Appendix B. Resume-ready project description

Suggested portfolio entry

SAP Ariba Adoption Intelligence & Procurement Transformation — Built an enterprise-style Excel analytics solution using a supplied SAP Ariba KPI catalogue and clearly labelled synthetic performance data. Structured 48 KPI definitions across five solution areas, modelled 17,280 sample records across 15 business units and 24 months, and developed executive, solution, KPI, regional and exception-management views. Documented KPI logic, data limitations, governance recommendations and a phased implementation roadmap.

Use wording such as 'portfolio simulation', 'designed', 'developed' and 'demonstrated'. Do not describe the fictional client as an actual employer or customer project.

Appendix D. Workbook reference

Primary workbook: SAP_Ariba_Adoption_Intelligence_Dashboard.xlsx

Key sheets to demonstrate during a portfolio walkthrough: Executive Dashboard → Solution Adoption → KPI Performance → Regional & BU Analytics → Exception Management → Strategic Insights → Data Dictionary & Methodology.